Waste Walk

Go and see how work really flows, spot the eight wastes, and pick the one worth removing first.

Manage Flow · Lean · Go and See (Gemba) · The Eight Wastes

PROCESS / TEAM _____

DATE _____

1 The Walk

GO WHERE THE WORK HAPPENS

Process we're walking: _____

Starts when: _____

Walkers: _____

Ends when: _____

- [ ] Watch real work, not the official process
- [ ] Ask, don't judge
- [ ] Note facts, not names

2 Waste Spotted

ONE STICKY PER EXAMPLE · UNDER THE WASTE IT BELONGS TO

Transport

Hand-offs between people and teams

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Inventory

Partly done work: started, not finished

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Motion

Switching between tasks and tools

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Waiting

Waiting for approvals, answers, environments

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Overproduction

Features nobody asked for or uses

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Over-processing

Gold-plating, extra reports, re-doing work

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Defects

Bugs, misunderstood requirements, rework

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

Unused skills

Not using what people know, or can learn

Examples

Seen: _____

Hours / week: _____

3 Biggest Wastes

BY COST, NOT BY COUNT

WASTE	WHERE WE SAW IT	COST PER WEEK	LIKELY CAUSE

4 Remove One

ONE CHANGE AT A TIME

Waste to tackle first: _____

Countermeasure: _____

Owner: _____

Check on: _____

- [ ] Stubborn or cross-team? Work it through on an A3 Problem-Solving board

"Where does work wait, and what are people doing while it waits?"

"Which waste, if we removed it, would give us the most time back?"

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